

Apoorv Vatsal

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PROFILE

I've spent the last seven years building things, fixing things, and helping companies grow. Started in audit, moved into investment banking where I worked directly with early-stage founders across healthcare, D2C, and deep-tech — not just evaluating them but helping them build strategy, shape their narrative, and raise capital. Now I run strategy and operations from a CEO's office at a scaling travel-tech platform, where I've shipped products, solved cross-functional problems worth crores, and built AI tools that teams actually use daily.

I'm a structured thinker who executes. I hold a CFA (Level III cleared) and am a semi-qualified CA — I can read a business deeply, model it, and then go build the thing that fixes it. I'm looking for a fast-moving company where strategy and growth aren't two separate departments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy & Operations – CEO's Office · Tripjack

Mumbai | Mar 2024 – Present

Tripjack is one of India's leading B2B travel-tech platforms. Embedded in the CEO's office — working across strategy, product, growth, and operations.

- Applied lean process methodology to identify and eliminate operational waste across group bookings — mapped the end-to-end value stream across ops, finance, invoicing, and documentation, surface leakages, and redesigned the process from scratch with built-in automations and reconciliations directly on the portal. Problem quantified at ₹50+ crores per annum.
- Led a lean-driven automation initiative that moved operational efficiency from 22% to 75% — diagnosing root causes, eliminating non-value-adding steps, and standardising workflows across teams. Savings to date: over ₹10 crores.
- Designed and built an AI-assisted sales governance platform from scratch — pipeline analytics, fuzzy duplicate lead detection, and automated data quality flagging. Actively used by the sales team for day-to-day governance.
- Managed end-to-end delivery of 7 product features, coordinating across engineering, product, and business teams from brief to launch.
- Built a Power BI business intelligence system adopted by the executive team for day-to-day decision making. Implemented governance frameworks that improved cross-team efficiency by roughly 50%.

Independent Investment Advisor · Stir Advisors

Ahmedabad | Nov 2023 – Mar 2024

Boutique M&A and transaction advisory firm working with early-stage companies and SMBs.

- Advised founders on M&A transactions — deal structuring, negotiations, and documentation through to close.
- Built investment theses and financial models to support buy-side and sell-side recommendations.

Investment Banking Associate · IBGRID

Ahmedabad | Jun 2022 – Nov 2023

Mid-market investment bank working with early-stage startups on fundraising and growth strategy across technology sectors.

- Worked hands-on with D2C and consumer brands — a whey protein manufacturer, a kitchen appliance startup (featured on Shark Tank India), and an ayurvedic baby care brand — helping each with business strategy, financial modelling, brand positioning, and investor narrative.
- Evaluated 55+ startups across deep-tech AI, healthtech, and travel-tech — building investment theses, valuation models, and competitive analyses.
- Built pitch decks and financial models for \$0.5M–\$3M fundraising transactions across 15+ companies; ran investor outreach including cold calling, demo days, and networking at CIIE.CO Ahmedabad. Several mandates closed successfully.
- Ran commercial and financial due diligence: validated business models, stress-tested financial projections, and assessed market positioning.

Audit Lead · PKF Sridhar & Santhanam LLP

Mumbai | Aug 2017 – Aug 2020

One of India's leading mid-tier CA firms.

- Worked across statutory audit, forensic audit, and tax engagements across insurance, manufacturing, F&B, and financial services clients — building a strong foundation in financial analysis and understanding how businesses actually work beneath the numbers.

EDUCATION

Credential	Institution	Year
CFA Level III – Cleared	CFA Institute	Feb 2023
Semi-Qualified Chartered Accountant	ICAI	2015 – 2021
B.Com Honours (Finance)	IGNOU	Dec 2019
Growth Strategy — User Acquisition, Engagement & Monetisation	GrowthX (GX17)	Nov 2023

SKILLS

Startup Support	Tools & Tech
Growth Strategy & Execution	Power BI
Go-to-Market & Brand Strategy	AI-assisted workflow tools
Financial Modelling & Fundraising	Excel (advanced modelling)
Process Design & Automation	Google Apps Script / No-code
Product Feature Delivery	DCF, Comparables, Research

SELECTED PROJECTS

- YouTube Music – User Acquisition Strategy: Full acquisition playbook including market sizing, user segmentation, and channel strategy. Selected as a Top Project in GrowthX GX17.
- LinkedIn – Onboarding Teardown: End-to-end teardown of LinkedIn's onboarding funnel with actionable redesign recommendations. Selected as a Top Project in GrowthX GX17.
- Scapia (Fintech) – Growth Model: Built a full-stack growth model to take Scapia from 10k to 100k MAU — acquisition, retention, and monetisation. 7-member capstone team.
- Signal – Hiring Platform: Built a full two-sided platform prototype replacing the CV with verified thinking assessments and blind candidate profiles. Live demo at apoorv-curious.github.io/Portfolio_AV/